

Three children can take sides in 6 ways, and 3 of those are one against one

Every possible split into two opposing sides, with anyone left over staying out of it.

These are possibilities, not arguments that happened — and the commonest case of all, nobody taking sides, is not among them.

 one side  the other side  staying out

A vs B and B vs A are the same split, and are counted once.

One against one — the sibling pairs (3 of 6)



A vs B

C stays out



A vs C

B stays out



B vs C

A stays out

One against two (3)



A vs B+C

nobody left out



B vs A+C

nobody left out



C vs A+B

nobody left out

Source: all 6 configurations for three children, enumerated · computed 2026-08-13, OEIS A000392, $S(n+1, 3)$ · exact counts, nothing estimated